

K4 Companion Windows Quick Start

The quickest way to get started with K4 Companion on Windows is to install it on a computer on the same local area (home) network as the K4. A laptop is recommended to simplify speaker settings, but a desktop computer with speakers and a microphone works too. Follow these steps:

- 1. Download and Install K4 Companion.** Download the installer from <https://github.com/DaleFarnsworth/K4-Companion/raw/main/Windows/k4companion-installer.exe>, and double-click k4companion-installer.exe in your Downloads folder. The installer is not signed, so Windows may say “Windows protected your PC”: click More info, then Run anyway, and then Yes to allow it to make changes. Follow the prompts. K4 Companion is installed in C:\Users\<your user name>\k4companion, with a desktop icon and a Start menu entry. An earlier version is removed first, when you click OK.
- 2. Configure the K4’s Server.** If you have not already done so, enter the server settings on the K4 (the K4’s own manual has details). Tap the small globe at the bottom left of the K4 screen. Create a password for remote users; it is mandatory, and the default password will not work. Set Max Clients to between 1 and 4, and close the window. Press Menu, to the right of the globe, and turn the main tuning dial until you see **IP Address**. Note the IP address and the password.
- 3. Start and Configure K4 Companion.** Double-click the K4 Companion desktop icon. It opens to the Server tab. Under Name, enter a name for this K4, in place of “K4 #1”; under Address[:Port], the K4’s IP address; and under Password, the K4’s server password. Press Tab after each. No port is needed: K4 Companion uses the K4’s encrypted port, 9204. It then connects and switches to the Main tab; if it does not, press the blinking yellow Connect button.

If you do not hear the K4’s audio, check the volume slider(s), then the Current Input and Output Devices on the Audio tab, such as “Microphone” and “Speaker” or the USB Audio Codec’s “Line” and “Speakers.” If the K4 gets no audio from your microphone, turn on “Microphone access” and “Let desktop apps access your microphone” in Windows Settings → Privacy & security → Microphone.
- 4. Optional: Your Own Paddles or Key.** In CW mode, the CW window opens; set up your key on its Keying tab (see the user manual) to hand key or use paddles.

You should now have full control of the K4 within the LAN, and a laptop on Wi-Fi stays connected from other rooms. The user manual covers the other tabs and functions, and, in its Remote Access section, connecting from outside your home network. The installer puts it in the k4companion folder, as K4 Companion User Manual.pdf; it is also in the Documentation folder of the K4 Companion repository on GitHub, <https://github.com/DaleFarnsworth/K4-Companion>.

If K4 Companion does not start, or misbehaves, run k4companion-debug.exe from the k4companion folder: the same program, with a console window showing messages that help when reporting a problem. To remove K4 Companion, use Settings → Apps → Installed apps, k4companion, Uninstall.